

History is no guide for Putin-Trump meeting

Relationship has grown more complicated

By Michael Crowley
NEW YORK TIMES

Standing beside Russian President Vladimir Putin in Finland's presidential palace on a midsummer's day seven years ago, President Trump proved that he still had the power to shock.

At a news conference after meeting privately with the Russian leader, Trump sided with Putin on whether the Kremlin had meddled in the 2016 US presidential election.

"President Putin says it's not Russia. I don't see any reason why it would be," Trump said, contradicting his own intelligence officials before recounting discredited conspiracy theories.

Top Republicans were horrified. Senator John McCain, Republican of Arizona, called it a "disgraceful performance." Trump's own national security adviser at the time, John Bolton, would later write that "Putin had to be laughing uproariously at what he had gotten away with in Helsinki."

Trump plans to see Putin on Friday in Alaska for the first time since his return to the White House to discuss the US president's goal of ending the war between Russia and Ukraine. With Putin pressing peace proposals that heavily favor Russia, many analysts and former Trump officials worry that he will once

PUTIN, Page A7

T to stay open an hour later on Fri., Sat. nights

Rides to be free after 9 p.m. as bonus for a month; past late-night efforts failed

By Jaime Moore-Carrillo
GLOBE STAFF

and Sadaf Tokhi
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Night workers and late-night partiers will soon get an extra hour to catch the train home on Friday and Saturday nights, as Boston again tries to shed its sleepy town image.

The MBTA announced Tuesday that it would extend service on all subway lines "by about one hour" on Fridays and Saturdays starting Aug. 24. Trains now typically begin their final runs between midnight and 1 a.m.

The agency also plans to lengthen nighttime service for select buses and ferries, including three Silver Line routes. Most MBTA buses operate between 5 a.m. and 1 a.m., according to the agency; some start earlier or end later.

And for one month beginning in September, all service after 9 p.m. will be free on Friday and Saturday nights.

The changes are the T's latest attempt to stretch transit service deeper into the night, long a cause célèbre of politicians and advocates who say the expanded schedules simplify commutes for late-night workers and help Boston leave behind its reputation as a strait-laced

LATE NIGHT, Page A10

A balancing act for D.C. mayor in dealing with the president

Despite toning down rhetoric, Bowser powerless to keep Guard members out of streets

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Democrat Muriel Bowser has been the mayor of the nation's capital for both of Donald Trump's presidencies. And she's taking a starkly different approach to its most famous resident this time compared to his first term.

The day after his 2017 inauguration, Bowser addressed the Women's March protest in a pink hat and led the crowd in a chant of "Leave us alone." When Trump

attacked her and Democratic New York Representative Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez, Bowser declared on Twitter, "I see @AOC and I are living in his head, and apparently there's a lot of empty room in there."

Bowser, 53, then publicly feuded with Trump over his response to the demonstrations after the 2020 murder of George Floyd, including the deployment of the National Guard in the city. That led to her most visible act of defiance, ordering "Black Lives Matter"

painted across two blocks near the White House in yellow letters so large they could be seen from space.

When Trump returned to the Oval Office in January, the writing was on the wall that Bowser would have a less combative approach.

She preached cooperation, traveling to his Florida estate in December to meet with him. And the day before Boston's Michelle Wu and three Democratic mayors sparred with Republicans over

Trump's immigration policies at a congressional hearing, Bowser offered the president a high-profile olive branch by announcing the removal of Black Lives Matter Plaza.

But despite the change in strategy, Bowser has ended up in the same place as five years ago: with National Guard troops on the streets of Washington, D.C.

This time, though, the federal intervention is even more pervasive.

D.C., Page A6



KAYLA BARTKOWSKI/GETTY IMAGES

On Tuesday, some of the 800 deployed National Guard members arrived. A6.

'By focusing on everything, Trump ensures that the public will not have a sustained focus on anything.'

ADAM J. BERINSKY,
a political science professor at MIT

All Trump all the time all Trump

Onslaught of news keeps Americans off balance or disengaged

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

In version 2.0 of the Trump presidency, the headlines, impactful and significant, have come fast and furious.

It's been nonstop since Jan. 20: immigration roundups that have included local high profile arrests; an ongoing effort to defund Planned Parenthood; a crusade against anything that the White House views as a DEI initiative; a continuing dogfight with the nation's most prestigious universities; the prospective dismantling of the federal Department of Education; the bombing of Iran; slashing health care for the poor.

The onslaught has prompted many Americans to tune out altogether, ignoring the norm-annihilating decisions and the federal turmoil. Perhaps they've become inured to the chaos. Perhaps that's the point, some experts say.

"I do believe that the 'flooding the zone' is a chosen strategy," said Adam J. Berinsky, a political science professor at MIT.

Most of the people, most of the time, do not pay close attention to politics, said Berinsky.

"By constantly shifting the focus of his actions to something new and dramatic, Trump ensures that the vast majority of Americans will not follow along with developments in any one area," he said. "In other words, by focusing on everything, Trump ensures that the public will not have a sustained focus on anything."

Indeed, the deluge was predicted by a former Trump adviser earlier this year. That's when Steve Bannon told Axios that the tsunami of news is intended to overwhelm the media "with so much activity on so many fronts that it cannot process."

Trump has also rolled back climate efforts, pausing

FLOOD, Page A6



More than just a sandwich

When a man threw a sub at a federal agent in D.C., it was another reminder that as a symbol of protest, food is potent. **G1.**

Israel is talking with South Sudan about the possibility of resettling Palestinians from the Gaza Strip there. **A3.**

The Suffolk Sheriff's Department spent tens of thousands of public dollars on recent junkets. **B1.**

Inflation was unchanged as rising prices for imported goods were balanced by falling gas and grocery prices. **B5.**

Open District Seven council seat draws big field focused on housing

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

Sarah Flint, a Roxbury resident of roughly 70 years, takes civic engagement very seriously, particularly in election years.

This year her focus is on one race in particular: who is going to represent her and the rest of District Seven, which comprises Roxbury, and parts of Dorchester, the South End, and Fenway, on the Boston City Council.

Who will win her support will depend on how they've served their community, she said, and how they plan to tackle her top priorities: public safety, the rising cost of housing, improving local schools, and support for seniors.

"I want to see what you've done," Flint said. "I'm not going to vote for you if you're not doing nothing to help me and my people."

The District Seven contest is one of this year's most consequential races, even as the city's attention is largely focused on the showdown between Mayor Michelle Wu and her chief challenger, Josh Kraft. It's the only open seat on the ballot, after former incumbent councilor Tania Fernandes Anderson pleaded guilty to federal corruption charges and stepped down in July. It's also drawn the most crowded field of candidates, with 11 people vying for the role.

Fernandes Anderson's dra-

matic downfall grabbed headlines, but for voters living in the district, other issues — particularly housing affordability, creeping gentrification, resources for kids and schools, and the substance use crisis that's spilled into their streets — are far more pressing, especially as voters decide who next to represent them.

"Roxbury always elects a fighter, so we're looking for someone who's going to be an advocate, a strong advocate who knows the issues," said Armani White, a lifelong Roxbury resident and executive director of the nonprofit Reclaim Roxbury.

Said Abdikarim is one of

DISTRICT 7, Page A10